James Praise

Lagos, Nigeria (Remote) | (+234) 812-654-6251
jamesspraise@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/jamespraise | jamespraise.xyz/work | github.com/realjaymes

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Generalist marketer who has been the first or early marketing hire at SaaS and fintech companies since 2018, and who runs his own newsletter. I own the whole funnel myself: positioning, launches, case studies, paid tests and the lifecycle that turns a signup into a paying user. I ship my own marketing sites with Claude Code and run a library of AI agent skills I built, so one person can cover a week of launches without the quality dropping. More at jamespraise.xyz/work/sparkloop.

Selected Achievements:

- Owned the product-led funnel at Reform, a conversion-focused form builder: **34% lift in trial activation** and **21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion**.
- Built the launch framework Reform used for every release: **26% lift in new feature adoption** within 90 days.
- Built Reform's partner program on **PartnerStack** from scratch, and earn affiliate income through PartnerStack links in my own newsletter.
- Grew the Marketing In Action newsletter to **5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate**.
- Ran a product showcase for Forage Mail across a newsletter, LinkedIn and creators: **1,689 readers, 36 to 41% open rates and 13+ verified trial signups**.

KEY SKILLS

Strategy: Positioning & Messaging, Product Launches, Product-Led Growth, Lifecycle & Onboarding, Case Studies & Customer Stories, Affiliate & Partner Programs, Experiment Design, Content Strategy

Execution: Launch Emails & In-App Announcements, Landing Pages, Paid Social & Search Tests, Newsletter Growth & Monetization, SEO & Content Engines, On-Camera & Video Content, Attribution & CAC Reporting

Tools: Claude Code, GA4, Google Tag Manager, Meta & TikTok Ads, Google Ads, HubSpot, Customer.io, Brevo, PartnerStack, Substack, Webflow, n8n

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PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder | Marketing In Action | Apr 2024 – Present
Marketing In Action (newsletter, academy and marketing services, Nigeria, US, UK)

- Grew the newsletter to 5,000+ subscribers at a 47% average open rate and 11% click-through rate, and monetize it through affiliate links.
- Ship the Marketing In Action website and my personal site myself with Claude Code: sales pages, landing pages, tools and pitch microsites.
- Built a paid-acquisition system across seven ad platforms that judges campaigns on backend sales instead of ad-platform reports; it caught Meta cross-crediting sales between products.
- Ran a product showcase for Forage Mail, an AI inbox assistant: 1,689 readers at 36 to 41% open rates and 13+ verified trial signups.

Product Marketing Manager | Reform | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
Reform (SaaS, MarTech, conversion-focused form builder, acquired by FunnelEnvy)

- Repositioned the product around lead conversion and rebuilt onboarding and lifecycle email: 34% lift in trial activation.
- Launched the Pro Plan Free Trial across web, email and in-app: 21% lift in trial-to-paid conversion.
- Built the Feature Launch Plan Framework for every release: 26% lift in new feature adoption within 90 days.
- Built Reform's partner program on PartnerStack from scratch: recruiting, incentives, tracking and swipe assets.
- Built an AI-assisted SEO engine and integration pages: 48% rise in non-branded organic traffic.

GTM Lead | FunnelEnvy | Feb 2024 – Apr 2026
FunnelEnvy (B2B, revenue funnel optimization service provider)

- Built a quarterly demand generation roadmap across outbound, lifecycle and paid: 40% quarter-over-quarter lift in qualified enterprise leads.
- Designed a cross-brand measurement stack (GA4, Looker Studio, Lightdash, HubSpot) that cut reporting time 50%.

GTM & Product Marketing Consultant | Komfot Health | Nov 2025 – Mar 2026
Komfot Health (B2C and B2B2C digital health, Nigeria, Rwanda, Benin)

- Defined the go-to-market structure for three countries and audited seven acquisition channels.

Head of Inbound Marketing & SEO | Distrobird | Feb 2024 – Apr 2024
Distrobird (sales engagement SaaS, US)

- Led a content team of five writers and two editors and ranked for 3,000+ competitive keywords in three months.

Head of Growth & Marketing | Bujeti | Sep 2023 – Feb 2024
Bujeti (YC W23, SaaS, fintech spend and expense management, Nigeria)

- Built the growth function as the first marketing lead, across product marketing, lifecycle, SEO, events and partnerships.
- Redesigned lifecycle email and in-app flows: 20% higher engagement and 10% lower churn.
- Generated 1,331 marketing qualified leads in six months and grew new B2B customers 500% in Q1 2024.

Chief Revenue Officer | Cecure Intelligence Limited | Jun 2022 – Sep 2023
Cecure Intelligence Limited (B2B technology and training provider, UK and Sub-Saharan Africa)

- Progressed from Sales Manager to Head of Growth & Marketing to Chief Revenue Officer.
- Launched the CIL Academy across five countries: 20,000+ community members and 10,000+ users in the first cohort at under $0.50 customer acquisition cost.
- Ran paid campaigns at 2 to 3x return on ad spend on $1.5K to $15K monthly budgets.

Marketing, Growth & GTM Roles | Multiple Companies | 2018 – 2022
B2B, SaaS, fintech, consumer brands and service businesses

- Product Marketing Manager at Bento Africa (payroll and HR fintech across four countries): 50% more sales qualified leads and 25% higher sales conversion from lifecycle nurture programs.
- Marketing & Growth Advisor at JegzFits Leatherworks (consumer brand, Nigeria, 2021 to present): Meta and TikTok acquisition held at about 8x return on ad spend as spend grew.

PROJECTS & PUBLIC WORK

- **Marketing Agent Skills** (github.com/realjaymes): AI agent skills for research, drafting, launches and reporting that I run daily in Claude Code, part of them open source.
- **Marketing In Action newsletter** (newsletter.marketinginaction.xyz): weekly practical marketing playbooks for operators.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- **MBA, Entrepreneurship & Innovation** | Miva Open University (2026) | CGPA: 4.92/5.0

- **Product Marketing PMMC™ Certification** | Product Marketing Alliance (2025)
- **BSc. Biochemistry** | University of Lagos (2018) | CGPA: 4.46/5.0